

Title

Efficacy Comparison of IL-23 Inhibition and PDE-4 Inhibition in Systemic Psoriasis Treatment

Abstract

Three hundred fifty-two adults with moderate plaque psoriasis were randomized to receive either subcutaneous IL-23 inhibitor (n = 118) or oral PDE-4 inhibitor (n = 234). At 16 weeks, the IL-23 inhibitor group achieved significantly higher rates of 90% or greater skin clearance (56.8% vs 5.3%, $p < 0.001$) and physician-assessed complete/nearly-complete clearing with marked improvement (75.4% vs 18.8%, $p < 0.001$). Among the oral agent group, participants not achieving treatment response threshold were re-randomized at week 16 to either switch to IL-23 inhibitor or continue their current therapy. At 52 weeks, those who switched to IL-23 inhibitor achieved 90% clearance in 72.2% of cases compared to only 2.6% who continued the original oral agent. The IL-23 inhibitor was well-tolerated; most frequent adverse events were upper respiratory tract infections and COVID-19. The oral agent group experienced higher rates of gastrointestinal side effects. Most participants in both groups reported improvement in psoriasis-related quality of life and reduced disease-related burden. These results demonstrate substantially superior efficacy of IL-23 inhibition compared with oral PDE-4 inhibition, particularly when given as initial therapy.